People who influence design

Higher · Design · Worksheet

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ describe the roles of designers, ergonomists, lawyers, production engineers, project managers, market researchers and materials technologists
- ☐ describe communication between members of a design team
- ☐ explain the advantages and disadvantages of in-house design teams and sub-contracting

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A company is developing a new electric scooter.

1 Describe the role of the ergonomist, the market researcher and the project manager. (6 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

The ergonomist provides anthropometric data for the target users ✓ and advises on the handlebar height and grip size ✓. The market researcher runs focus groups to find what users want ✓ and reports on competitors and an acceptable price ✓. The project manager sets the schedule and budget ✓ and coordinates the team to meet deadlines ✓.

Why marks are not awarded

"The ergonomist makes it comfortable. The market researcher does research. The project manager manages the project."

0 marks: each restates the job title.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

2 Explain one benefit and one drawback of using sub-contractors. (2 marks)

Sentence starters

Benefit: …

Drawback: …

Word bank

higher · confidentiality · benefit · needed · drawback · specialist · unreliable · skills

Tip: 2 marks = 2 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) Who provides data on hand grip sizes for a target market?
☐ Ergonomist ☐ Lawyer ☐ Production engineer ☐ Retailer

b) Which is a disadvantage of using an external designer?
☐ Fresh ideas ☐ Specialist skills ☐ Higher fees and IPR issues ☐ Only hired when needed

c) Who would apply for a patent on a new mechanism?
☐ Project manager ☐ Lawyer ☐ Ergonomist ☐ Market researcher

d) Who checks a design can be made efficiently and economically?
☐ Consumer ☐ Manufacturer ☐ Marketing team ☐ Retailer

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Role of a retailer**	____	**A** Advises on material properties and suitable manufacturing methods.
2. **Role of a manufacturer**	____	**B** Feedback on sales, what will sell and market trends.
3. **Role of a marketing team**	____	**C** Ensures the product can be made efficiently and economically.
4. **Materials technologist**	____	**D** Plans how the product is priced, promoted and sold.
5. **Production engineer**	____	**E** Plans production rate, volume, tooling and system.

5 Describe the role of a lawyer in a design team. (2 marks)

6 Describe the advantage of sub-contracting. (2 marks)

Check and reflect

Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?